Dear Professor Mohammed Atiquzzaman,

We are pleased to submit our manuscript entitled **"Risk-Aware Predictive Vertical Handover for UAV Communications in Heterogeneous Wireless Networks"** for consideration for publication in *Vehicular Communications*.

**Summary of the work.** Unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) operating in heterogeneous wireless networks face significant vertical handover (VHO) challenges, including decision latency, ping-pong handovers, and fixed attribute weights that cannot adapt to dynamic channel conditions. This paper proposes LAAVHA, an adaptive VHO algorithm that integrates stacked-LSTM state prediction, attention-based dynamic weighting, improved TOPSIS with fused current and predicted states, and dual-hysteresis decision-making. LAAVHA is further enhanced with adaptive dynamic hysteresis (ADH) and risk-sensitive TOPSIS (RS-TOPSIS) to form ALERA. Across 250 extended 50-second trajectories, LAAVHA achieves the lowest mean handover count among 11 algorithms, reducing handovers by 46%–95% versus eight baselines while maintaining the highest throughput and lowest delay. ALERA preserves necessary handovers under sustained degradation while suppressing false handovers under transient channel variation.

**Relevance to Vehicular Communications.** This work addresses handover decision-making for aerial vehicles in heterogeneous wireless networks, a topic of growing importance as UAVs are increasingly integrated into 5G and beyond-5G infrastructure. The proposed algorithms are directly applicable to vehicle-to-network communication scenarios, making this work well suited for the scope of *Vehicular Communications*.

**Prior submission history.** An earlier version of this manuscript was submitted to *Remote Sensing* (MDPI) and was not accepted. The manuscript has been substantially revised and reframed to focus on vehicular communication aspects, with new experiments, expanded algorithm descriptions, and a thorough reorganization of the presentation.

**Declaration.** This manuscript has not been published previously and is not under consideration for publication elsewhere. All authors have approved the manuscript and agree with its submission to *Vehicular Communications*. The authors declare no competing financial interests.

We hope that this work will be of interest to the readership of *Vehicular Communications* and look forward to the reviewers' feedback.

Yours sincerely,

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